LESSON 3

Mary had a little lamb

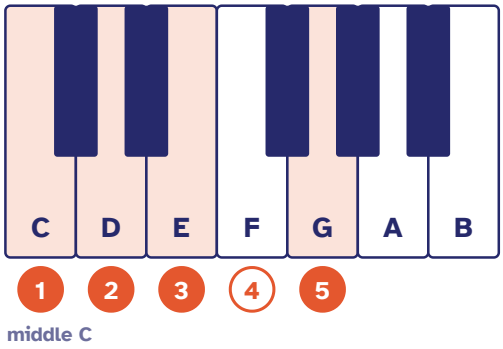
A rhyme by Sarah Josepha Hale, first printed in Boston in 1830, about a lamb that followed a girl to school. We sing it to the tune of *Merrily we roll along*.

IN THIS SONG **4/4** **four notes: C D E G** **the C position** **steps and a skip**

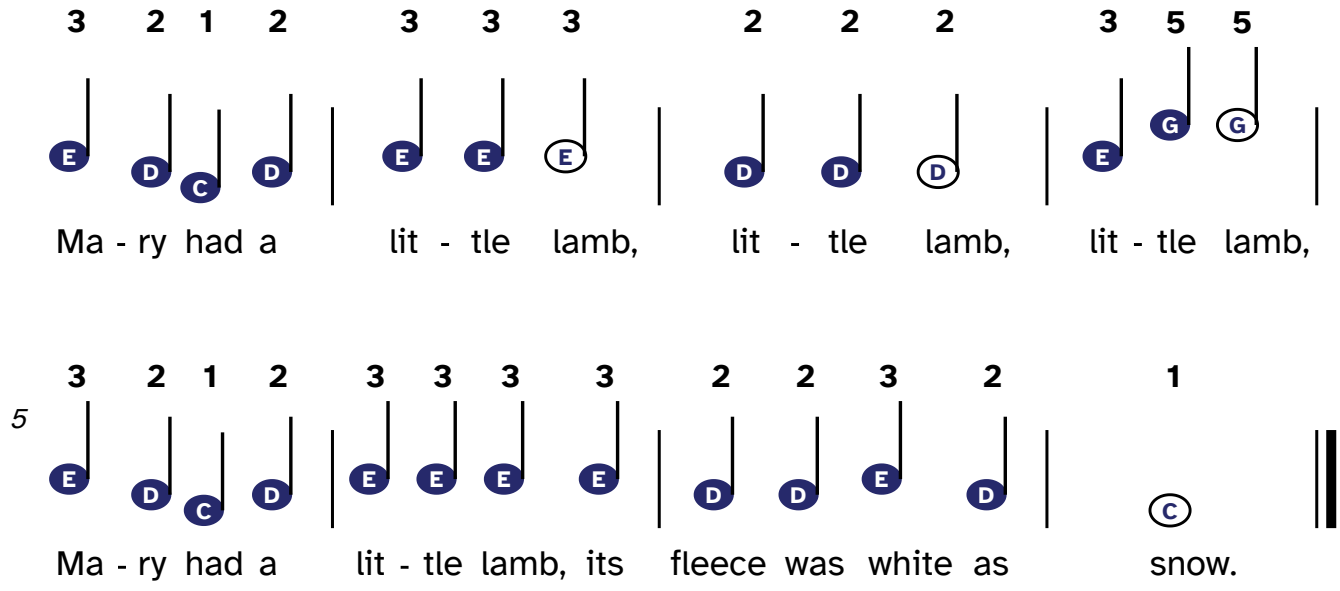
LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note as it sounds. Then sing it with the words.



Your hand: C position. Right thumb on middle C, a finger on each key up to G. The song's notes are lit.
Steps and a skip. Most notes move by a step, to the next key. Only once does the tune skip a key: E up to G.



☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Sang it with the words**

2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

THE RHYTHM

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE TIME

4/4

Top 4: four beats in every bar.

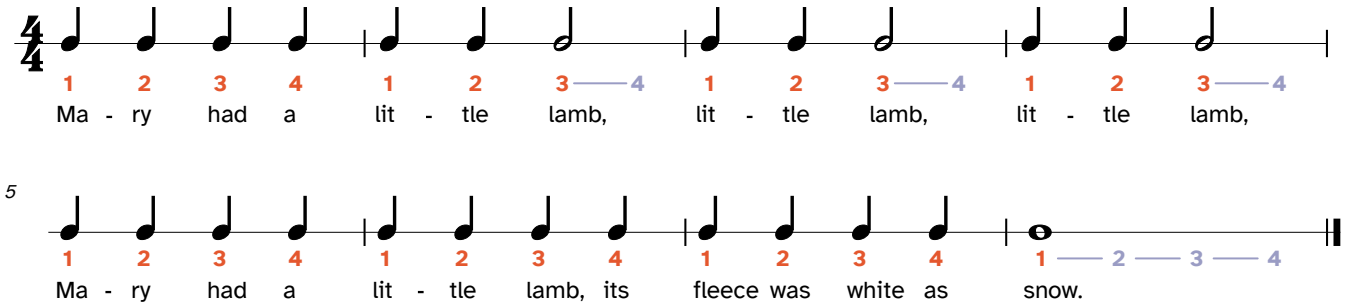
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

crotchet — 1 beat ●

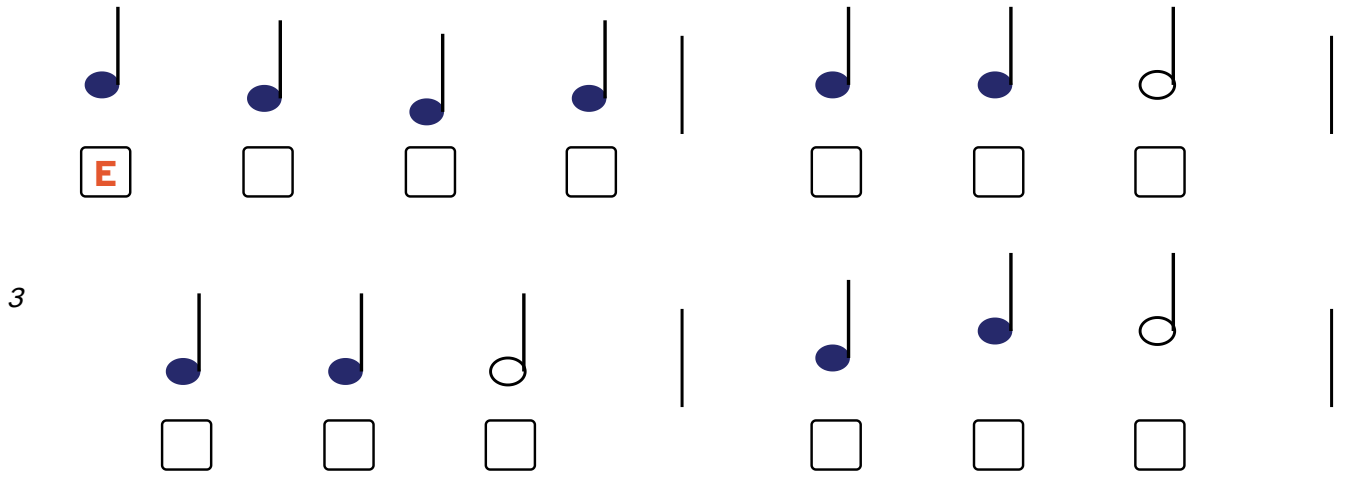
minim — 2 beats ●●

semibreve — 4 beats ●●●●



THE NOTES

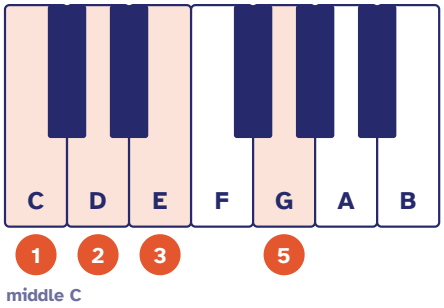
Write the letter name of every note in the first four bars; the first one is done. Then find the skip: in which bar does the tune jump from E up to G? ☐



☐ **Said it in time** ☐ **Clapped and counted** ☐ **Wrote the letter names** ☐ **Found the skip**

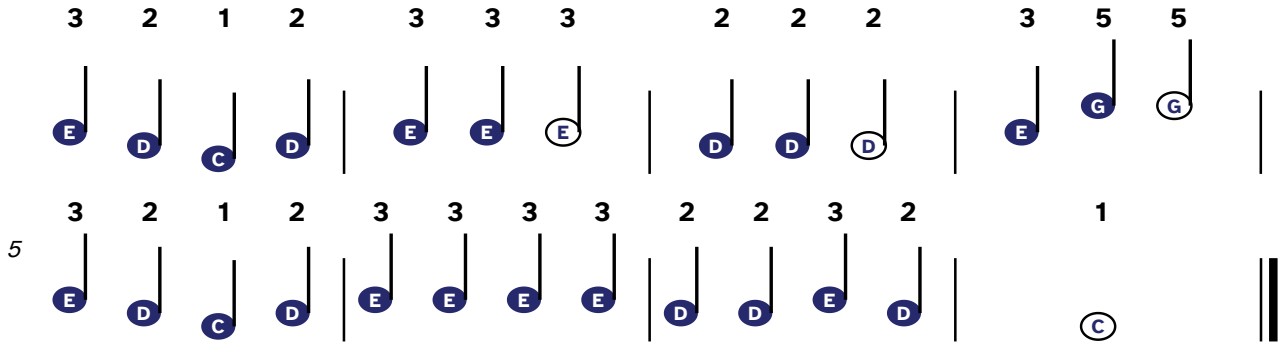
3 Play it

Four white keys now, C D E and G: the right hand, then the left.

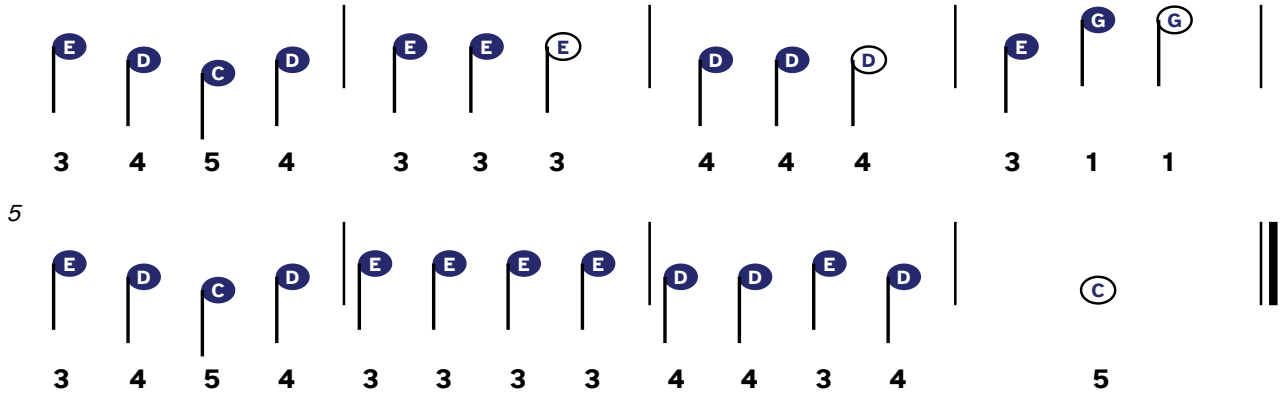


Right hand: the C position, thumb on middle C: 1 on C, 2 on D, 3 on E, 5 on G. **Left hand:** an octave lower, 5 on C, 4 on D, 3 on E, thumb on G.

R RIGHT HAND the C position



L LEFT HAND an octave lower



4 · CHECK

- ☐ I can say and clap it
- ☐ I can sing it with the words
- ☐ I can find the skip, E up to G

I can play it:

☐ Right hand ☐ Left hand

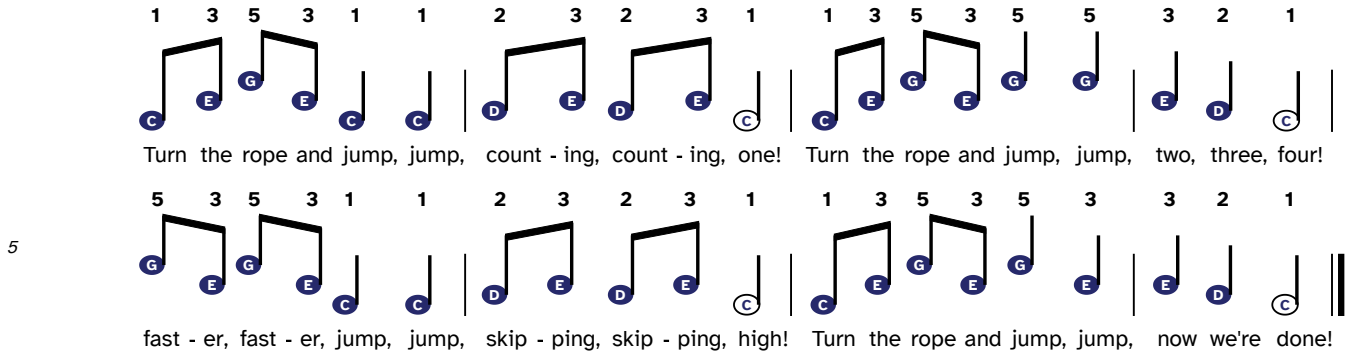
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

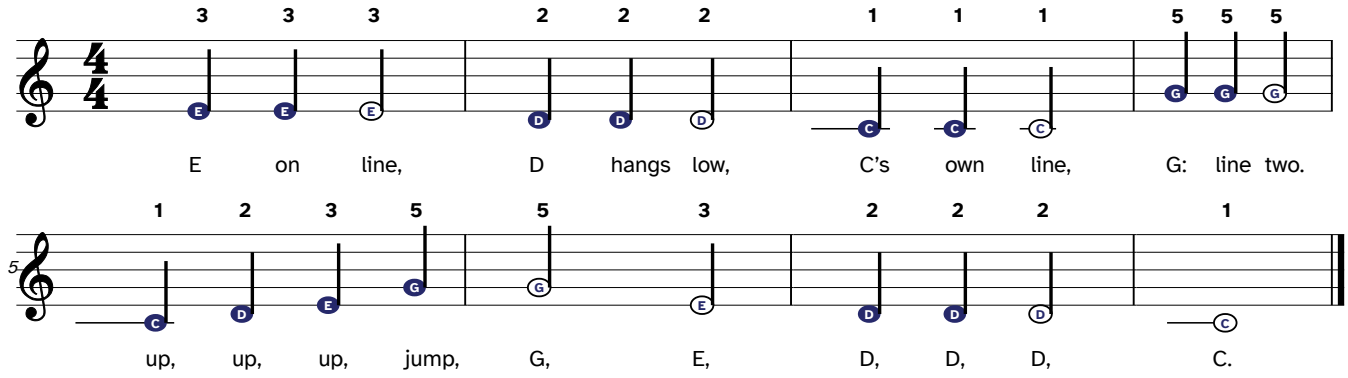
JUMP ROPE

Bouncy and quick: the four keys with skips, C E G, like a rope going round. Keep the running notes light.



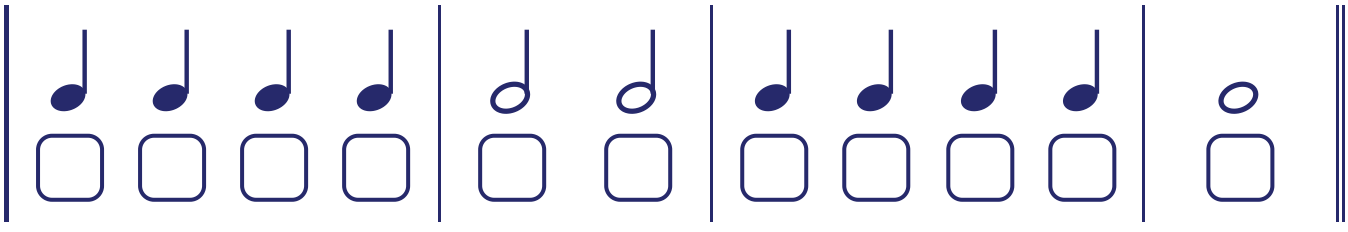
HELLO, STAFF

Calm and careful, a peek at Lesson 4: the same notes on five lines. E sits on the bottom line, D hangs below it, C has a little line of its own, G sits on line two.



YOUR OWN TUNE

Write a letter in each box, then play your tune. Give it a name:



- [ ] Played the first tune
- [ ] Played the second tune
- [ ] Played my own tune